

## Cognition in the Age of AI (85-414/814)

### Optional readings and other resources:

These materials are not required, but may be useful in gaining some background knowledge for this course, and a deeper dive into some advanced topics.

#### Getting started with Colab and PyTorch:

- More about Google Colab:
  - [https://colab.research.google.com/notebooks/basic\\_features\\_overview.ipynb](https://colab.research.google.com/notebooks/basic_features_overview.ipynb)
- More tutorials in PyTorch:
  - <https://docs.pytorch.org/tutorials/beginner/basics/intro.html>
  - [https://pytorch.org/tutorials/beginner/nn\\_tutorial.html](https://pytorch.org/tutorials/beginner/nn_tutorial.html)
  - [https://pytorch.org/tutorials/beginner/pytorch\\_with\\_examples.html](https://pytorch.org/tutorials/beginner/pytorch_with_examples.html)

#### Other neural network coding tutorials:

- [Neuromatch academy](#) offers online courses in topics related to this class:
  - [Computational Neuroscience](#)
  - [Deep Learning](#)
  - [NeuroAI](#)
- The materials from these courses are all openly available (as Colab notebooks). You can check these out for further advanced exploration of course topics.

#### Introduction to neural network concepts for beginners:

- Intro to neural networks:
  - <https://victorzhou.com/blog/intro-to-neural-networks/>
- Intro to convolutional neural networks:
  - <https://www.pinecone.io/learn/series/image-search/cnn/>
  - <https://towardsdatascience.com/convolutional-neural-networks-for-beginners-c1de55eee2b2/>
  - <https://colah.github.io/posts/2014-07-Understanding-Convolutions/>
- Intro to language models:
  - <https://mark-riedl.medium.com/a-very-gentle-introduction-to-large-language-models-without-the-hype-5f67941fa59e>
  - <https://developers.google.com/machine-learning/crash-course/llm>
  - <https://huggingface.co/learn/llm-course/chapter1/1>

- Intro to self-attention and transformers
  - Illustrated Transformer: <https://jalammar.github.io/illustrated-transformer/>
  - <https://jalammar.github.io/visualizing-neural-machine-translation-mechanics-of-seq2seq-models-with-attention/>
- Linear algebra:
  - A nice video series reviewing basic concepts in linear algebra (3Blue1Brown): [https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLZHQObOWTQDPD3MizzM2xVFitgF8hE\\_ab](https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PLZHQObOWTQDPD3MizzM2xVFitgF8hE_ab)

### **Blogposts exploring the inner workings of neural networks:**

- Curve detectors in CNNs: <https://distill.pub/2020/circuits/curve-detectors/>
- CNN feature visualization: <https://distill.pub/2017/feature-visualization/>
- Interpreting LLM features (Claude): <https://transformer-circuits.pub/2024/scaling-monosemanticity/index.html>
- Multimodal neurons in LLMs: <https://distill.pub/2021/multimodal-neurons/>
- Superposition and interpretability: [https://transformer-circuits.pub/2022/toy\\_model/index.html](https://transformer-circuits.pub/2022/toy_model/index.html)

### **Longer review articles that overview neural networks and deep learning:**

This one is especially good for neuroscience/psychology background:  
 Kriegeskorte (2015), Deep Neural Networks: A New Framework for Modeling Biological Vision and Brain Information Processing.  
<https://doi.org/10.1146/annurev-vision-082114-035447>

LeCun, Y., Bengio, Y. & Hinton, G. Deep learning. Nature 521, 436–444 (2015).  
<https://doi.org/10.1038/nature14539>

### **More theoretical discussion & critiques of deep networks for neuroscience:**

Kanwisher, Khosla, & Dobs (2023). Using artificial neural networks to ask ‘why’ questions of minds and brains. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tins.2022.12.008>

Saxe, Nelli, & Summerfield (2021). If deep learning is the answer, what is the question?  
<https://doi.org/10.1038/s41583-020-00395-8>

Richards et al (2019) A deep learning framework for neuroscience  
<https://doi.org/10.1038/s41593-019-0520-2>

Guest & Martin (2023). On Logical Inference over Brains, Behaviour, and Artificial Neural Networks. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s42113-022-00166-x>

Bowers et al. (2022). Deep problems with neural network models of human vision. <https://doi.org/10.1017/s0140525x22002813>

### **Learn more about functional magnetic resonance imaging (fMRI):**

- fMRI 4 Newbies – by Jody Culham (Western University)
  - <https://www.fmri4newbies.com/lectures>
- UCSD CFMRI:
  - <https://cfmriweb.ucsd.edu/Research/whatisfmri.html>
- Details of MR physics etc:
  - <http://mriquestions.com/index.html>

### **Learn more about the human visual system:**

- DiCarlo, J. J., & Cox, D. D. (2007). Untangling invariant object recognition. Trends in cognitive sciences, 11(8), 333–341. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tics.2007.06.010>
- Grill-Spector, K., Weiner, K (2014). The functional architecture of the ventral temporal cortex and its role in categorization. Nat Rev Neurosci 15, 536–548. <https://doi.org/10.1038/nrn3747>
- Entry by Matteo Carandini about early visual processing:
  - [http://www.scholarpedia.org/article/Area\\_V1](http://www.scholarpedia.org/article/Area_V1)
- Lecture notes from David Heeger at NYU (these are shared for several topics):
  - <https://www.cns.nyu.edu/~david/courses/perception/lecturenotes/V1/lgn-V1.html>